
BONANZA CREEK
GOLD MINING & PANNING SIMULATOR
PLAYABLE NOW · STEAM EARLY ACCESS APRIL 2027




Every pan could be the big one.

# Dig, pan, sell, upgrade. The ground is real













### Every bite removes ground

Dig anywhere on a 65 × 65 m claim, 24 m deep today.

### The gold is really there

It follows an old river channel you learn to read. No loot table.

### It scales

Sluices wash, hired rigs dig, ore carts haul. 5 rigs and 3 carts in today's build.

# Something to find every few minutes




## Wall glints

A nugget in your very first cut, and more winking from pit walls.




## The map tin

A torn claim map marks where a cache lies, 6–14 m away.




## The buried cache

Dig where the map says and lift a strongbox of nuggets.




## The deep pit

Keep digging: real ground, layer by layer, 24 m down.

# Inspired by




## Gold Mining Simulator

2017 · $19.99
**15,172** reviews · 72%

Your own claim to mine




## Hydroneer

2020 · $14.99
**27,308** reviews · 85%

A camp built from nothing




## Digging A Hole

2025 · $4.99
**19,055** reviews · 89%

Digging can be the hook




## PowerWash Simulator

EA 2021 · $24.99
**51,100** reviews · 96%

Calm work done by hand



Steam store data, read 30–31 Oct 2026. Base US price, all-language reviews, % positive.

# This shelf sells in the millions




## 2M+

**copies, PC + consoles**

Gold Mining Simulator
Code Horizon, Feb 2025




## 1M+

**copies on Steam**

Hydroneer
developer, 2026




## 1M+

**copies in 4 months**

Digging A Hole
publisher, Jun 2025



Copies sold, as announced by each developer or publisher.

# Playable today

| | |
|---|---|
| GENRE | First-person gold prospecting sim |
| IN THE BUILD | 65 × 65 m claim, 24 m deep · sluices · 5 rigs · 3 ore carts |
| MODE | Single-player |
| PLATFORMS | Windows, macOS, Linux · Steam Deck by Early Access |
| ENGINE | Godot 4.7 |
| PLAYTIME | 4–6 h at Early Access · 15–20 h at 1.0 (targets) |
| HOUR 1 → 10 | Shovel and pan → water monitors → rigs, rails, ore carts |
| PRICE | $14.99 (proposed) |
| BUILDS | bonanzacreek.lifewheel.us |



# Early Access April 2027, 1.0 November 2027

| Oct 2026 | Dec 2026 | Feb 2027 | Apr 2027 | May 2027 | Jul 2027 | Nov 2027 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Now** | **Steam page** | **Next Fest** | **Early Access** | **The Creek** | **The Canyon** | **1.0** |
| Playable build | Store page live | Public demo | Excavator, The Mole | Second claim | Third claim | Neighbour claims |
| Home claim, 24 m deep | Trailer | Press and creators | Ground to 40 m | New river geology | Bedrock tools | 1.0 trailer |
| Sluices, rigs, carts | Wishlists open | | 8 languages, Steam Deck | | | Creator keys |
| **Self-funded** | **$20k at signing** | **$15k** | **$25k** | **$13k** | **$13k** | **$7k** |

# One founder, contractors per milestone



## Alex · founder, design and code

**$550k**
LifeWheel App Store sales, almost all organic

**17 yrs**
commercial software, 10+ as lead or senior

**Playable**
the full loop, today, on three platforms

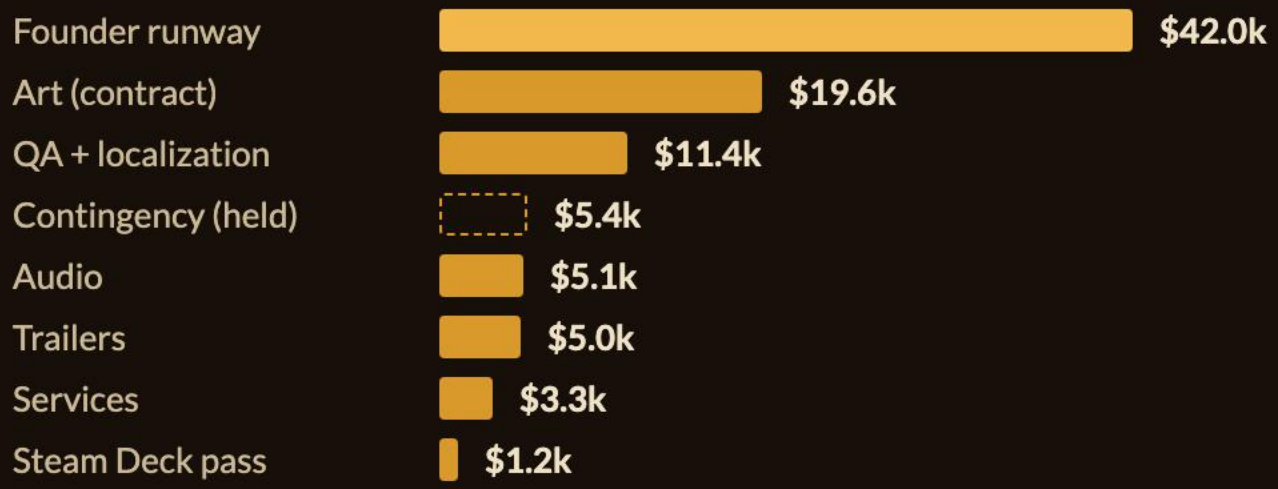
**Why this game:** of the 25 games I've built, this one drew the best engagement and feedback. It took off on itch.io before SIM Jam voting even began.

**Contractors per milestone:** 3D art, key art, music, QA, localization.

# Paid in six milestones, signing to 1.0

## $93,000

About $7.8k a month · PC build to 1.0 · excludes marketing and ports




### Payment schedule

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Dec 2026 | Signing | $20k |
| Feb 2027 | Next Fest demo | $15k |
| Apr 2027 | Early Access build | $25k |
| May 2027 | Creek claim | $13k |
| Jul 2027 | Canyon claim | $13k |
| Nov 2027 | 1.0 | $7k |
| TOTAL | each paid on a delivered build | $93k |

**From a partner:** marketing, PR, events, console ports.

**Contingency** is held in cash from signing and drawn only against a named overrun.



# Like Bonanza Creek?
# Let's talk.

Alex · **alex@lifewheel.us**

Play: bonanzacreek.lifewheel.us

**SCAN TO PLAY**
PC builds and the gameplay video